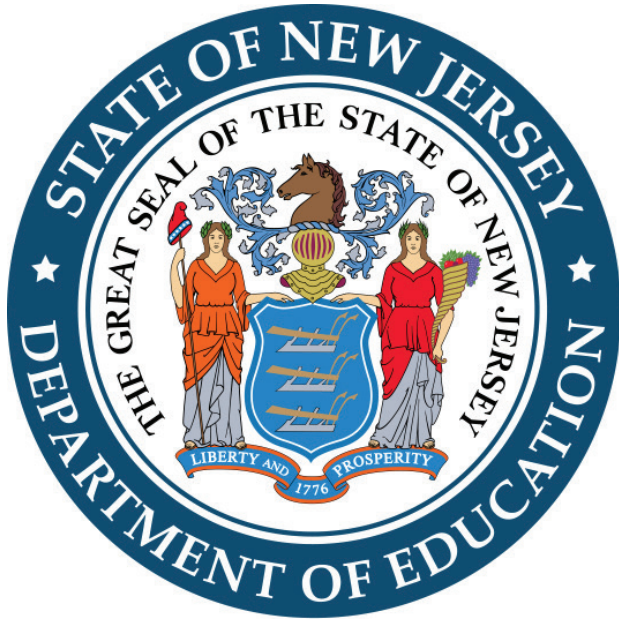




New Jersey
Student Learning
Assessments-Adaptive

Practice Test

English Language Arts

Grade 5

Student Name _____

Directions:

Today, you will take the Grade 5 English Language Arts Practice Test. If you do not know the answer to a question, skip it and go on to the next question. If you have time, go back to the questions you skipped and try to answer them before turning in your Student Test Booklet.

1. Read each passage and question. Then, follow the directions to answer each question.
2. Fill in the circle next to your answer choice or choices.
 - If you change your answer, make sure you erase your old answer completely.
 - Do not cross out or make any marks on the other choices.
3. One of the questions will ask you to write your answer.
 - Write your answer in the space provided in your Student Test Booklet.
 - Be sure to keep your answer within the provided space.

Softball

by Sonja Skye Wooley

A softball player is nervous when it is her turn to bat, and when her team needs her the most.

1 I stood in the box, wriggling my toes around in my cleats along with the sand that had somehow managed to wedge itself in there. . . .

2 *Another hit, and I'm up, I thought, another hit and all the pressure is on me.*

3 It's not that I don't like softball, because I do. I love throwing and catching with my teammates, going to batting cage. But the prospect of batting in a real game makes me want to crawl under a rock for a few weeks. Behind me, in the dugout, I could hear my teammates cheering. That gave me a little courage but not much.

. . .

4 My team really needed a hit. The score was one-to-two, in our opponent's favor. . . . My only experience with batting was swinging and missing, swinging and missing.

. . .

5 I panicked, trying to remember everything I had ever learned about batting in a split second. The ball landed short at my feet, but I still made a wobbly swing.

6 "Strike!" called the umpire. I winced.

7 *No! You knew that was a grounder, I thought, why didn't you leave it alone?*

. . .

8 Next pitch the softball whizzed by my shoulders and I didn't do anything.

9 "Strike two!"

10 But when the next ball rolled my feet, I was ready for it, staying stiffly where I was. Three more softballs hit the dirt and my bat didn't move. I looked up in surprise as one of the coaches rolled out the blue pitching machine. Had I really gotten four balls?

11 Something like hope stirred up inside of me. The pitching machine! . . .

- 12 The coach brought his hand up and around, just like a real pitcher, and released. I tensed and then something inside me clicked. I was going to swing at that ball and *hit it*.
- 13 The ball was almost upon me, I tensed, waited for just the right moment, and then swung. Hips first, then elbows, then bat just like my coach had taught me only twenty minutes before.
- 14 Ball hit bat.
- 15 The clang echoed around in my mind. I had done it! I hit the ball!

Excerpt from "Softball" by Sonja Skye Wooley. Copyright © 2017 by Stone Soup Magazine. Reprinted by permission of Children's Art Foundation via Copyright Clearance Center.

1. How does the narrator's fear of disappointing her team help develop the theme?

- Ⓐ By showing how strong she is, she proves others wrong.
- Ⓑ By realizing that having fun is the important part, she continues to play.
- Ⓒ By learning a new sport, she understands it is important to try new things.
- Ⓓ By remembering what she has learned, she believes she has the ability to succeed.

2. Read this sentence from the passage.

"But the prospect of batting in a real game makes me want to crawl under a rock for a few weeks." (paragraph 3)

What does the phrase "crawl under a rock" show about how the narrator feels about batting?

- Ⓐ She is scared and wants to avoid batting.
- Ⓑ She is angry and wants to leave the field.
- Ⓒ She is frustrated and wants to try batting.
- Ⓓ She is embarrassed and wants to start over.

3. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

How does the author structure the plot of the passage??

- Ⓐ by describing the pitches in order
- Ⓑ by comparing the game to another one
- Ⓒ by describing what every player is doing
- Ⓓ by listing the players taking turns batting

Part B

How does the structure in Part A affect the story?

- Ⓐ It creates a feeling of chaos at the softball game.
- Ⓑ It explains why the players feel the way that they do.
- Ⓒ It makes the experience of hitting seem less important.
- Ⓓ It builds excitement about whether the narrator will succeed.

4. How does the narrator react to the last pitch differently than she does to the first pitch?
- Ⓐ On the last pitch, the narrator is more proud.
 - Ⓑ On the last pitch, the narrator is more rested.
 - Ⓒ On the last pitch, the narrator is more amused.
 - Ⓓ On the last pitch, the narrator is more confident.
5. How does the narrator's nervousness affect the way the game is described?
- Ⓐ It shows how important the hit is to her.
 - Ⓑ It shows how new playing softball is to her.
 - Ⓒ It shows how exciting being at-bat is to her.
 - Ⓓ It shows how confusing the strikes are to her.

Writing**Directions:**

Read the writing prompt and sources. Then write your final essay on pages 13 through 15. Check over your essay when you are finished.

Writing Prompt

Write an informative essay to present to your class about the problem of light pollution in the United States today. Use information from the sources in your essay.

Manage your time carefully so that you can

- read the sources;
- plan your response;
- write your response; and
- revise and edit your response.

Be sure to include

- an introduction;
- information from the sources as support; and
- a conclusion that is related to the information presented.

Your response should be in the form of a multiparagraph essay. Write your response in the space provided.

Light Pollution

Source 1: A Light Pollution Study Near You

by Noreen Grice

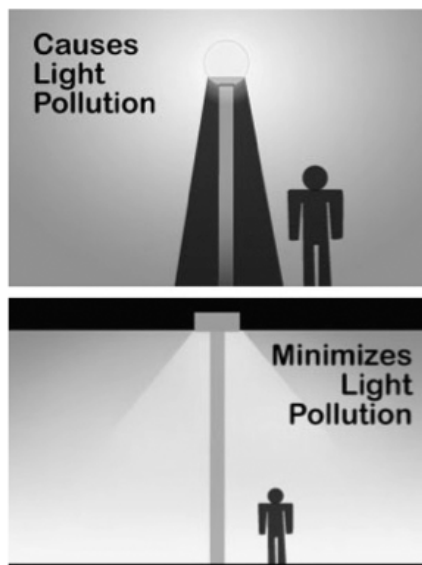
- 1 Thousands of years ago, people looked up at the starry night sky and saw thousands of twinkling stars. They imagined star patterns and star gods; the night sky was a major part of their lives. Ancient sky watchers timed the rising of certain stars or sky patterns and used them as a sky calendar to help decide when to plant and harvest certain crops. . . .
- 2 Today, the nighttime sky has changed, and for some people it has almost disappeared.
- 3 If you live in a big city, ask yourself, “What looks brighter . . . the lights in the buildings or the lights in the sky?” The answer most likely will be that the lights in the buildings are brighter than the stars.
- 4 Businesses that operate at night must have lighting, that’s obvious. But now let’s add in light from street poles and highways, security lights, sports fields, and lit billboards. When you combine all these sources of light, you have so much that it actually illuminates the night sky and makes it hard to see the stars.
- 5 A satellite photograph of North America . . . shows that the most populated areas—particularly Boston; New York; Washington, DC; Chicago; Los Angeles; and generally along the east and west coasts—have the most light output at night. Here, it is almost impossible to do any sky watching at night.
- 6 “Light pollution” is the term that describes the effect of artificial lights on the night sky. But there are concerns even greater than just the increased difficulty of seeing stars. Some studies of light pollution show environmental impacts, with changes in animal behavior and plant growth. For example, birds blinded by lights glowing in high-rise office buildings have become disoriented and flown into the buildings. . . .
- 7 If you live in a light-polluted area, try this simple technique for naked-eye viewing: Cup your hands around your eyes to block out some of the unwanted background light. How much better is your view now?

“A Light Pollution Study Near You” by Noreen Grice, from *Odyssey*. Copyright 2005 by Carus Publishing Company. Reprinted by permission of Carus Publishing Company via Copyright Clearance Center.

Source 2: Sources of Light Pollution

by Renee Bauer

- 8 Light pollution happens when artificial lights make it hard to see the night sky. Most light pollution is caused by outdoor lights, such as street lamps. Many outdoor lights shine upward or sideways. This light escapes upward. It scatters and brightens the night sky. The brightness makes the sky harder to see.
- 9 Air pollution can also cause light pollution. Air pollution happens when harmful particles are released in the air. These particles can harm people, plants, and animals. The particles also make light pollution even worse. They make more light scatter at night.
- 10 Outdoor lights that send all light downward reduce light pollution. These lights are called *full cut-off* lights. They are called full cut-off lights because they give no direct uplight.
- 11 Another way to reduce light pollution is to use less powerful lamps or bulbs.
- 12 Look at the diagram. The top shows an example of poor outdoor lighting. The light shines upward and sideways, which causes light pollution. The bottom shows an example of good outdoor lighting. The light shines downward. This minimizes light pollution.



"Sources of Light Pollution" by Renee Bauer. Written for educational purposes.

Source 3: Light Pollution

by Catherine Clarke Fox

- 13 In most situations, light helps us see. But when it comes to looking at the night sky, light is actually a kind of pollution.
- 14 It hampers our view of some of life's most spectacular sights: stars, planets, and even galaxies. "When I was a little boy, I loved the night sky," recalls Robert Gent of the International Dark-Sky Association, an organization working to reduce light pollution.
- 15 "I remember looking up and the sky was filled with stars, and I asked, 'How many are there? How far away are they? Can we visit them?' I became an astronomer because I was amazed by their beauty," he says. "Now in most big cities kids can't see the stars like I did."
- 16 Normally, about 2,500 individual stars are visible to the human eye without using any special equipment. But because of light pollution, you actually see just 200 to 300 from today's suburbs, and fewer than a dozen from a typical city.
- 17 Only one in three Americans can see our own galaxy, the dazzling Milky Way, with the naked eye. Those people live far away from the lights of big cities, office buildings, and shopping malls. . . .
- 18 Many cities and towns have passed laws limiting lights at night, making sure enough shine for safety without creating a lot of light pollution.
- 19 Light pollution affects more than our view of the heavens. Research shows that lots of nighttime light can harm wildlife.
- 20 Migrating birds sometimes fly over cities and become confused by the brightness, flying in circles until they drop from exhaustion. Sea turtles need dark beaches for nesting and won't approach bright lights. Too much light at night may even affect human health; scientists are still learning more.
- 21 For all these reasons, researchers are working on ways to use lights only when and where they are truly needed. "Everyone deserves to look up at the infinite sky and wonder about the unbounded universe," says Gent.

"Light Pollution" by Catherine Clarke Fox, from <http://kids.nationalgeographic.com/explore/space/light-pollution.html>. Copyright by National Geographic Kids. Reprinted by permission of National Geographic Kids.

FINAL COPY

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

FINAL COPY

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

FINAL COPY

Lined area for writing.



Paper Practice Test Answer and Alignment Document: ELA

Grade 5 Reading

Passage: Softball

Item Sequence	Answer Key	Standards Alignment
1	D	RL.CI.5.2
2	A	L.VI.5.3
3	Part A: A Part B: D	RL.TS.5.4
4	D	RL.IT.5.3
5	A	RL.PP.5.5

Grade 5 Writing

Source 1: A Light Pollution Study Near You

Source 2: Sources of Light Pollution

Source 3: Light Pollution

Item Sequence	Answer Key	Standards Alignment
1	Refer to the grade 4-5 informative/explanatory writing rubric.	W.IW.5.2